17.4 Asthma in Children*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Child says, "My chest feels tight." **Objective** • Wheeze; RR 40/min • Speaks in short phrases only • SpO_2 92%	**ACTUAL** Ineffective breathing pattern related to bronchospasm as evidenced by wheeze, tachypnea and difficulty speaking.	• Speaks in full sentences with SpO_2 94% or above within 2 hours.	• Give the inhaled bronchodilator by spacer or nebulizer as prescribed. • Give oral or IV corticosteroid as prescribed. • Give oxygen to the target SpO_2. • Keep him upright and calm, with his parent.	• Outcome reached as breathing improves.
Subjective • Mother says, "I am not sure how to use the spacer." **Objective** • Spacer used incorrectly • Preventer doses missed	**ACTUAL** Inadequate health knowledge [parental] related to inhaler and spacer use as evidenced by incorrect technique.	• Before discharge, the parent uses the spacer correctly.	• Demonstrate a spacer with mask or mouthpiece suited to his age. • Watch the parent do it back. • Give a written asthma action plan.	• Considered met when the technique is correct.
Subjective • Father smokes indoors **Objective** • Exposed to dust and smoke	**RISK** Risk for physical injury as evidenced by risk factors: exposure to asthma triggers at home.	• Parents describe ways to cut down triggers.	• Advise no smoking in the home or car. • Teach ways to reduce dust. • Teach the early signs of an attack.	• Goal reached when the parents describe a plan.

*References for this care plan: [25], [35], [38]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.